Salesforce Certified Tableau Data Analyst

Full Practice Paper (60 Questions) - generated from the Master Cheat Sheet
Exam code: Analytics-DA-201 | 60 scored items | 105 minutes | Pass = 65% (39/60)

Item	Detail
Questions	60 (mirrors the 60 scored knowledge items of the real exam)
Time allowed	105 minutes (~105 seconds per question)
Passing target	65% -> 39 / 60 correct
Question types	Multiple choice (1 answer) and multiple select (SELECT 2 / SELECT 3)
Scoring	No partial credit - a multi-select item is correct only when every selected option is exact
Materials	Closed book. You may flag and revisit; there is no penalty for guessing

Domain	Weight	Questions	Topic focus
1. Connect & Transform Data	24%	Q1-Q14	Live/extract, joins vs relationships vs unions, Prep, filters, field roles
2. Explore & Analyze Data	41%	Q15-Q39	LODs, calculated fields, table calcs, filters, parameters, sets/bins, maps, analytics
3. Create Content	26%	Q40-Q55	Charts, sorting, dashboards, actions, formatting
4. Publish & Manage	9%	Q56-Q60	Publishing, refresh, alerts, subscriptions, Prep Conductor

Answer every question - unanswered questions score zero in the real exam. Check your work against cheat-sheet-answer.pdf only after finishing.

Domain 1 - Connect to and Transform Data (24%) - Q1-Q14

Q1. A retail chain wants a wall-mounted dashboard that always reflects the live state of its transaction database, which is updated continuously throughout the day. The database can comfortably handle the query load. Which connection type should the analyst use?

An extract refreshed every 15 minutes
A live connection to the database
An extract with incremental refresh enabled
A data blend between two extracts

Q2. An analyst must analyse a large dataset on a laptop while travelling with no network access, and also needs the workbook to open and respond quickly. Which option should they create?

A live connection to the database
An extract of the data
A custom SQL query against the live source
A data source filter on a live connection

Q3. Which statement about the .hyper file format is TRUE?

It is the legacy format that has been replaced by .tde
It is Tableau's newer, high-performance extract format, preferred over .tde
It can only store aggregated data, never row-level data
It cannot be published to Tableau Server or Tableau Cloud

Q4. Your team publishes a governed data source on Tableau Cloud, and you want to build a workbook on it from Tableau Desktop. How should you connect?

File > Open and browse to the published data source

Data > Paste the data into a new source
On the Connect pane, choose To a Server > Tableau Server / Tableau Cloud, sign in, then select the published data source
Drag the published data source from the Analytics pane

Q5. A workbook's charts are built on Sales_Q3.xlsx. Finance delivers Sales_FY.xlsx with identical field names, and every existing sheet must use the new file without rebuilding anything. What should you do?

Manually re-point each worksheet to the new file
Data menu > [current data source] > Replace Data Source...
Create a union between the two Excel files
Duplicate the workbook and start again

Q6. Before analysis, which THREE are aspects of data quality that the analyst should assess? **[SELECT 3]**

Completeness
Consistency
Accuracy
Compression ratio
Colour palette

Q7. Twelve regional CSV files all have exactly the same columns, and you want to stack all their rows into one table. Which operation should you use?

Join
Relationship
Union
Blend

Q8. You have an Orders table (many rows per customer) and a Customers table (one row per customer). You want both kept at their native granularity and combined only when queried, without duplicating customer rows. Which method should you use?

An inner join on Customer ID
A relationship between the two tables
A union of the two tables
A cross join on Customer ID

Q9. An Excel workbook contains a report title row, merged header cells, subtotal rows and footnotes. Tableau shows generic field names such as F1, F2, F3. Which feature cleans this automatically at connect time?

Pivot
Split
Data Interpreter
Wildcard union

Q10. A sheet stores monthly revenue as twelve separate columns named Jan, Feb ... Dec. You need Month and Revenue as rows so you can chart a trend over time. Which operation should you perform?

Split the month columns
Pivot the twelve columns into rows
Apply Data Interpreter
Create a group of the columns

Q11. A [Customer Name] field contains values like 'Smith, John'. You need 'Smith' and 'John' in separate fields without writing a calculation. Which feature should you use?

Split
Pivot

Alias
Data Interpreter

Q12. You want to limit the rows physically written into an extract to only the last three years of orders, applied when the extract is created or refreshed. Which filter should you use?

A context filter on a worksheet
A dimension quick filter on a single sheet
An extract filter defined on the extract
A table calculation filter

Q13. A [Customer ID] field appears as a green measure and is being summed, but you need each Customer ID listed individually as a category on the Rows shelf. What should you do?

Change its aggregation from SUM to COUNTD
Convert the field from a measure to a dimension
Wrap it in a FIXED LOD expression
Change its number format to text

Q14. A numeric field is being treated as a discrete dimension, so it produces row headers instead of an axis. Which change gives a true numeric axis?

Convert it to a measure
Create an alias
Convert it from discrete to continuous
Add it to a set

Domain 2 - Explore and Analyze Data (41%) - Q15-Q39

Q15. What does the calculation DATEDIFF('day', #2024-01-31#, #2024-02-02#) return?

0
2
3
-2

Q16. You need a label that shows the month as text, e.g. 'March'. Which calculation should you use?

DATEPART('month', [Order Date])
MONTH([Order Date])
DATENAME('month', [Order Date])
DATETRUNC('month', [Order Date])

Q17. The text string '17/06/2024' (day/month/year) must be converted into a true date value. Which calculation is correct?

DATE("17/06/2024")
DATEPARSE("dd/MM/yyyy", "17/06/2024")
DATEPARSE("MM/dd/yyyy", "17/06/2024")
DATENAME("day", "17/06/2024")

Q18. What does MID("Tableau", 2, 3) return?

"Tab"
"abl"
"ble"
"lea"

Q19. A [Company] field contains values such as 'Acme Inc.'. You want every occurrence of 'Inc.' replaced with 'Incorporated'. Which function should you use?

FIND([Company], "Inc.")
REPLACE([Company], "Inc.", "Incorporated")
SPLIT([Company], "Inc.", 1)
TRIM([Company])

Q20. You want to classify each row by profit: below 0 -> 'Loss', exactly 0 -> 'Break-even', otherwise 'Profit'. Which calculation is correct?

IF [Profit] < 0 THEN "Loss" ELSEIF [Profit] = 0 THEN "Break-even" ELSE "Profit" END
IF [Profit] < 0 OR [Profit] = 0 THEN "Loss" ELSE "Profit" END
CASE [Profit] WHEN "Loss" THEN 0 ELSE 1 END
IIF([Profit] > 0, "Loss", "Profit")

Q21. Which statement about the CASE expression is TRUE?

CASE must always include an ELSE clause
CASE evaluates one expression against a series of WHEN values, and the ELSE clause is optional
CASE can only be used with numeric fields
CASE is a table calculation that runs after aggregation

Q22. Which calculation displays the average discount rounded to one decimal place?

ROUND(AVG([Discount]), 1)
ROUND(AVG([Discount]), 0)
AVG(ROUND([Discount], 0))
INT(AVG([Discount]))

Q23. A CSV imports [Store Number] as a string, but you need it as a whole number for arithmetic. Which function should you use?

STR([Store Number])
INT([Store Number])
DATE([Store Number])
SPLIT([Store Number])

Q24. Sales is NULL for some rows. Which TWO calculations return 0 when Sales is NULL and the Sales value otherwise? **[SELECT 2]**

ZN([Sales])
IFNULL([Sales], 0)
ISNULL([Sales])
[Sales] + 0

Q25. You need the number of unique customers who purchased in each region. Which aggregate function should you use on [Customer ID]?

SUM([Customer ID])
COUNT([Customer ID])
COUNTD([Customer ID])
ATTR([Customer ID])

Q26. Finance wants the total Profit for the entire data source to appear on every row of any view, no matter which dimensions are present. Which calculation should you use?

SUM([Profit])
{FIXED : SUM([Profit])}

{INCLUDE : SUM([Profit])}
{EXCLUDE : SUM([Profit])}

Q27. A view shows SUM(Sales) by Region and by State. You add {EXCLUDE [State] : SUM([Sales])} as a second measure. What does the new measure show on each State mark?

The individual state's sales
The region total, repeated on each state in that region
The grand total of all regions
NULL, because EXCLUDE cannot be aggregated

Q28. Monthly sales are Jan = 10, Feb = 20, Mar = 30, Apr = 40. The calculation WINDOW_AVG(SUM([Sales]), -2, 0) computes along the table (down). What value is shown for April?

25
30
40
10

Q29. A crosstab shows SUM(Sales) by Category. What is the fastest way to display each category's share of the grand total?

Write {FIXED : SUM([Sales])} and divide
Right-click SUM(Sales) > Quick Table Calculation > Percent of Total
Add a parameter and a calculated field
Add a forecast from the Analytics pane

Q30. Monthly sales are Jan = 100, Feb = 50, Mar = 200, Apr = 50. RUNNING_SUM(SUM([Sales])) computes down the table. What value is displayed for March?

200
150
350
400

Q31. Four states have sales 100, 80, 80, 50 (descending). The business wants ranks 1, 2, 2, 3 - tied states share a rank and no rank numbers are skipped. Which function should you use?

RANK()
RANK_UNIQUE()
RANK_MODIFIED()
RANK_DENSE()

Q32. Which table calculation returns a row's position within its partition, starting at 1?

INDEX()
FIRST()
LAST()
SIZE()

Q33. A worksheet has a normal dimension filter on City and a Top 10 filter on Customer Name. The Top 10 is being computed across all cities instead of within the selected city. How do you fix the order of operations?

Add the City filter to context so it runs before the Top 10 filter
Change the Top 10 filter to a Bottom 10 filter
Convert both filters to table calculation filters
Remove the City filter and use a parameter instead

Q34. Which THREE are valid uses of a parameter? **[SELECT 3]**

Inside calculated fields (e.g. what-if analysis, swapping measures)
With filters (e.g. a Top N control: 'Top N by Sales')
With reference lines (e.g. a user-adjustable target line)
To store many selected values at the same time
To physically change the underlying data source

Q35. Which statement correctly distinguishes a set from a group?

A group is dynamic and updates as data changes, while a set is static
A dynamic set (e.g. Top 10 by Sales) updates automatically as data changes, while a group combines members and is static
Sets can be created only from measures, never from dimensions
Groups and sets behave identically in every way

Q36. To build a histogram of Order Quantity from scratch, what must you create?

A set on Order Quantity
A bin from the continuous Order Quantity measure
A hierarchy containing Order Quantity
A group on Order Quantity

Q37. Management wants a fixed monthly sales target of $50,000 drawn across a whole line chart of monthly sales. Which Analytics pane object should you add?

A constant reference line at 50,000
An average line
A trend line
A distribution band

Q38. You want each U.S. state shaded by its unemployment rate to compare regions quickly. Which map type should you use?

A symbol map
A density map
A filled (choropleth) map
A line map

Q39. Which statement is TRUE about Tableau's default forecast?

It is added from the Analytics pane and uses exponential smoothing by default
It can only be added to a scatter plot
It cannot be customised in any way
It uses hierarchical clustering to assign clusters

Domain 3 - Create Content (26%) - Q40-Q55

Q40. Using data with Genre and Revenue, you want a pie chart in which each slice's size reflects Revenue. How should you configure the marks?

Revenue to Colour, Genre to Angle, Revenue to Label
Genre to Colour, Genre to Label, Revenue to Angle
Genre to Size, Revenue to Colour, Revenue to Detail
Revenue to Size, Revenue to Label, Genre to Detail

Q41. Which configuration builds a histogram of Order Quantity?

Create a bin from Order Quantity, place the bin on Columns and CNT (Count) on Rows
Place Order Quantity on Colour and Category on Rows

Place Order Quantity on Rows and Sales on Columns with Dual Axis
Use Measure Names on Columns and Measure Values on Rows

Q42. You have placed SUM(Sales) and Profit Ratio on the Rows shelf and want them combined on one chart with independent scales. What creates the dual axis?

Right-click the second measure pill (or the right axis) and choose Dual Axis
Change the mark type to Line
Add a table calculation to one measure
Add a reference line to the view

Q43. You want nested rectangles whose area represents Sales and whose colour represents Profit. Which chart type should you use?

A highlight table
A treemap
A Gantt chart
A box plot

Q44. You want a scatter plot showing the relationship between Sales and Profit at the customer level, with points coloured by Profit Ratio. How should you build it?

Sales on Columns, Profit on Rows, Customer Name on Detail, Profit Ratio on Colour
Sales on Columns, Profit on Rows, Profit Ratio on Size only
Customer Name on Columns, Sales on Rows
Sales on Colour, Profit on Size, Profit Ratio on Rows

Q45. You need to show each project task as a horizontal bar that spans its start and end dates. Which chart type should you use?

A Gantt chart
A histogram
A symbol map
An area chart

Q46. A bar chart of Category is sorted alphabetically. You want the bars sorted by SUM(Sales) descending instead. What should you do?

Drag the Sales pill above Category on the shelf
Right-click the Category pill > Sort > Sort by Field: Sales (Sum), Descending
Convert Category to a continuous field
Add INDEX() as a hidden filter

Q47. Users want the product categories listed in a specific business order that is neither alphabetical nor based on a measure. Which feature should you use?

A manual (custom) sort order applied to the dimension
A quick table calculation
A set action
A wildcard filter

Q48. On a dashboard, which container arranges its child sheets side by side?

A horizontal container
A vertical container
A floating layout
A text object

Q49. Which statement about story points is TRUE?

A story point can be a worksheet or a dashboard
A story point can only be a worksheet
A story point can only be a dashboard
Story points cannot be reordered

Q50. Clicking a region on a map should filter the other worksheets on the same dashboard. Which dashboard feature should you use?

A filter action
A highlight action
A URL action
A tooltip

Q51. Clicking a product bar should open that supplier's website in a browser, passing the clicked Product ID into the web address. Which dashboard feature should you use?

A URL action with the Product ID field inserted into the URL
A filter action
An image object
A Web Page object with a fixed URL

Q52. When a user selects a mark on one sheet, you want related marks in other sheets to be visually emphasised (dimmed/highlighted) without removing any data. Which action should you use?

A highlight action
A filter action
A URL action
An extract filter

Q53. You want users to switch which sheet is displayed in a dashboard zone using an on-screen control. Which approach should you use?

Create a parameter that holds the sheet names and use it to drive the displayed sheet (sheet swapping)
Add a filter action between the sheets
Add a URL action to the zone
Add a highlight action

Q54. You want viewers to move from one dashboard to another in the same workbook by clicking a button. Which feature should you use?

A navigation button
A reference line
A filter action
An annotation

Q55. Your brand team wants a company-specific custom colour palette to be available in the colour dropdown for every workbook on the machine. Where must it be defined?

In the Preferences.tps file in the My Tableau Repository folder
In the workbook's XML file only
In the data source connection properties
In the dashboard's layout settings

Domain 4 - Publish and Manage Content (9%) - Q56-Q60

Q56. Several workbooks across the company must all use the same governed, cleaned dataset with a single definition. What should you publish so others can connect to it?

A published data source from Tableau Desktop or Tableau Prep
Each workbook with its own embedded copy of the data
A story containing all the sheets
A screenshot of the data

Q57. Which statement about exporting and printing Tableau content is TRUE?

Views can be exported as PDF, images (PNG/JPEG) or Excel, and dashboards/worksheets can be printed for people without Tableau
Views can only ever be exported to PDF
Exporting content removes the need for permissions
Printing a view requires a live connection

Q58. A transaction table holds hundreds of millions of rows and appends only yesterday's new rows each night. A full refresh takes hours. What should you schedule so each refresh only adds new rows?

An incremental extract refresh
A data source filter
A subscription
A live connection with a context filter

Q59. A manager wants to be emailed automatically whenever daily sales fall below $10,000. Which feature should you use?

A data-driven alert
A subscription
An extract refresh
A custom sort

Q60. You need a cleaned Tableau Prep flow to run automatically on a schedule on Tableau Server or Tableau Cloud. What is required?

Publish the flow and run it via Tableau Prep Conductor (part of the Data Management add-on)
Save the flow as a .tde file
Keep Tableau Prep Builder open on a desktop each night
Nothing - all published flows run on a schedule automatically

End of paper. Score yourself: 39+/60 = passing range; target 48+/60 (80%) before booking.